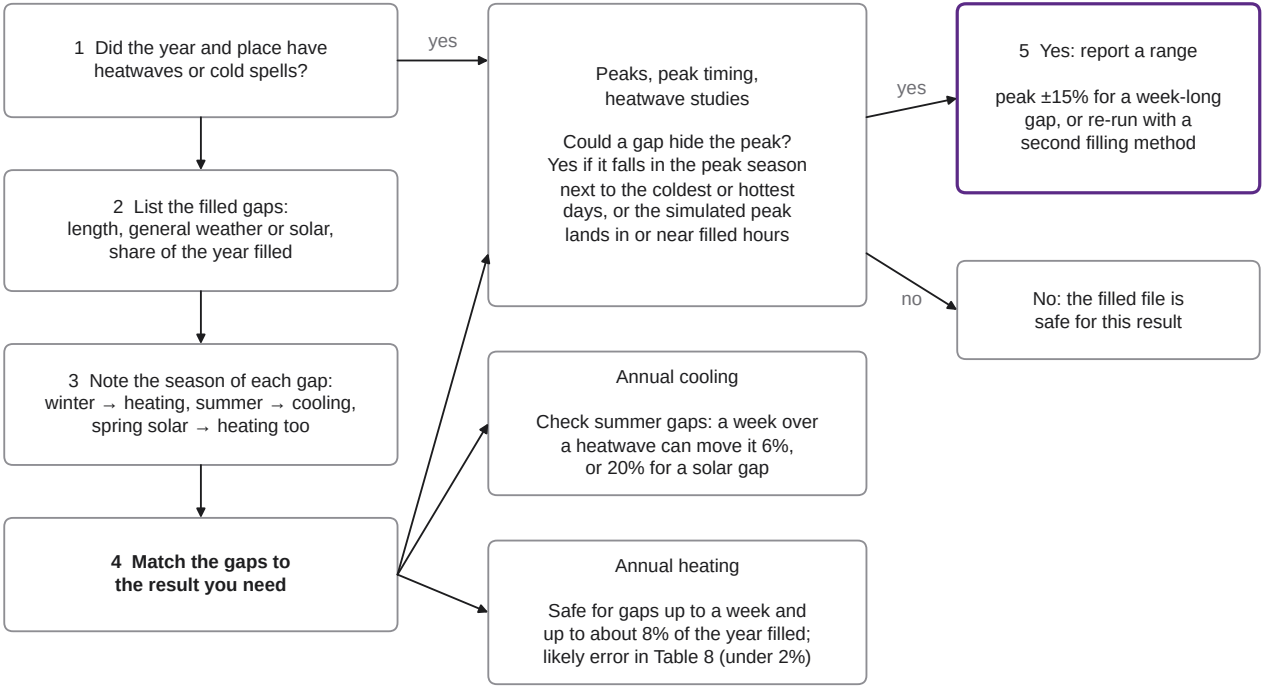
1 Did the year and place have heatwaves or cold spells?
yes
2 List the filled gaps: length, general weather or solar, share of the year filled
3 Note the season of each gap: winter → heating, summer → cooling, spring solar → heating too
4 Match the gaps to the result you need
Peaks, peak timing, heatwave studies
Could a gap hide the peak? Yes if it falls in the peak season next to the coldest or hottest days, or the simulated peak lands in or near filled hours
yes
5 Yes: report a range
peak ±15% for a week-long gap, or re-run with a second filling method
no
No: the filled file is safe for this result
Annual cooling
Check summer gaps: a week over a heatwave can move it 6%, or 20% for a solar gap
Annual heating
Safe for gaps up to a week and up to about 8% of the year filled; likely error in Table 8 (under 2%)